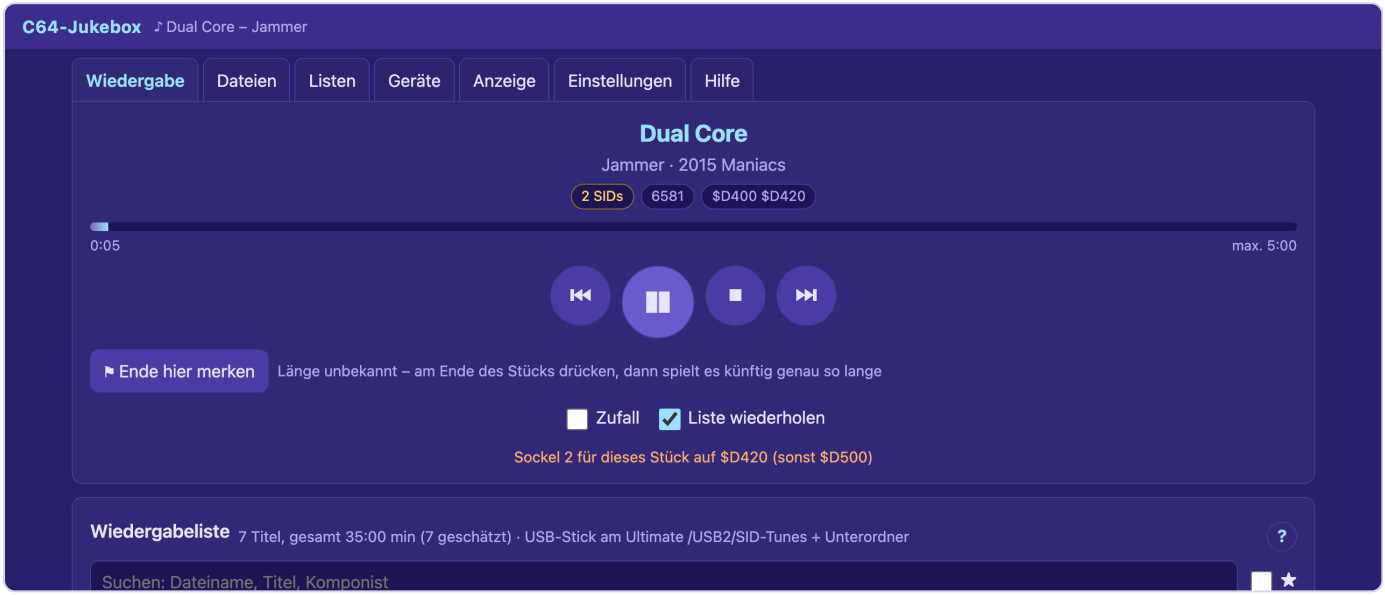
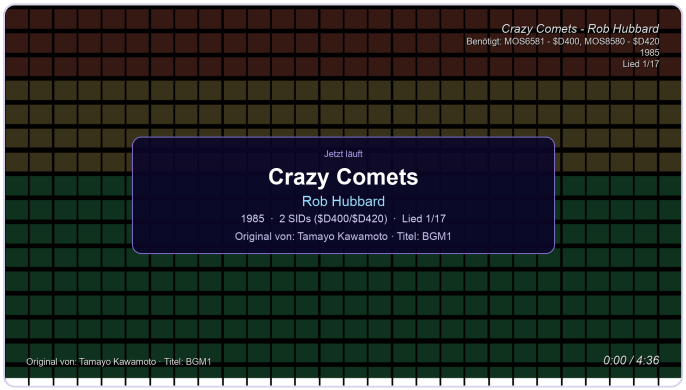
C64 Jukebox – Operation

Operating the SID jukebox on the Raspberry Pi: from the web page (phone or PC) and on the TV with its remote control



The web page on the PC: current tune and playlist



On the TV: a style with the “now playing” card



The menu on the TV, worked with the TV's remote

1 · Three ways to operate it
2 · The web page
3 · Choosing music
4 · Playback and the list
5 · Lists
6 · Devices
7 · Display: TV and screen
8 · Settings
9 · On the TV
10 · Remote control and menu
11 · Touch display on the Pi
12 · Quick help

This guide shows how to operate the jukebox. Installation, hardware and all details are in its manual (German) – in the web page under the tab **Hilfe** (every round **?** button jumps to the right place) and as `docs/HANDBUCH.md`. **The web page and the TV menu are in German**; buttons and menu items are quoted here as they appear, in *italics* with a translation. The pictures show sample data.

1 · Three ways to operate it

With	What you can do	Requirement
Web page phone, tablet, PC	**Everything:** choose and play music, lists, settings, TV, Ultimates, Picos.	browser in the same network, address **http://c64pi.local/**
The TV's remote control	Play, stop, change tune and sub-tune, change the style – and through the **menu on the TV** choose music, shuffle, lengths, choose the Ultimate, switch it on/off.	Pi on an HDMI input, HDMI-CEC switched on at the TV
Touch display on the Pi 2.8″, optional	Shows tune, levels and network; buttons ⏮ ■ ⏭.	display connected

> **How to get to the web page:**
>
> 1. Open **http://c64pi.local/** in the browser. If the name does not work (on some Android phones), use the Pi's IP address – it is shown on the TV next to the **QR code** (just scan it with the phone's camera) and on the Pi's display.
> 2. Log in with the web password (factory setting `commodore64` – a yellow bar reminds you to change it under *Einstellungen* → *Web-Passwort*).
> 3. Tip for the phone: **“Add to Home Screen”** in the browser menu – the jukebox then opens like an app.

The jukebox keeps playing on its own, even when no page is open. All open pages show the same state – start on the phone and carry on at the PC.

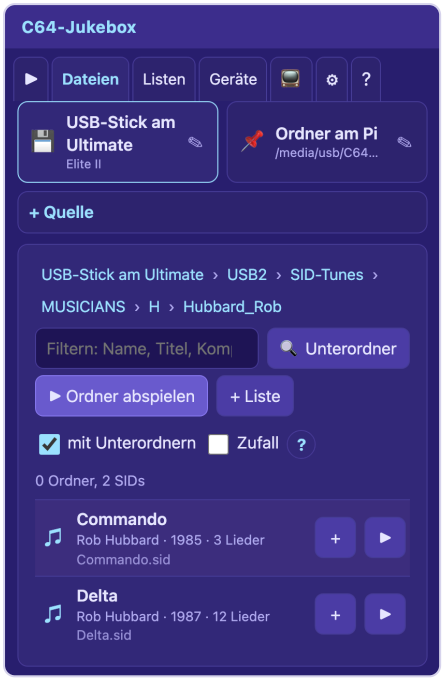
2 · The web page

At the very top is always the **current tune**. Below are the tabs – on the phone partly as symbols:

Tab	Phone	Content
Wiedergabe (playback)	▶	current tune, buttons, sub-tune, shuffle, playlist
Dateien (files)	Dateien	sources (NAS, FTP, USB sticks), folders, filter, search, play
Listen (lists)	Listen	saved playlists, ready-made compilations, “recently played”, statistics
Geräte (devices)	Geräte	Ultimates (which one plays, on/off), Picos and stream distributor, devices in the network
Anzeige (display)	📺	TV (styles, background, sound, retro news, remote control) and the Pi's display
Einstellungen (settings)	⚙	playback, timer, song lengths, the Pi's network, password, backup
Hilfe (help)	?	the manual

Short messages (“Gespeichert” – saved, “Commando – spielt” – playing) appear at the bottom for a few seconds. The round **?** buttons on the cards open the manual at the right place.

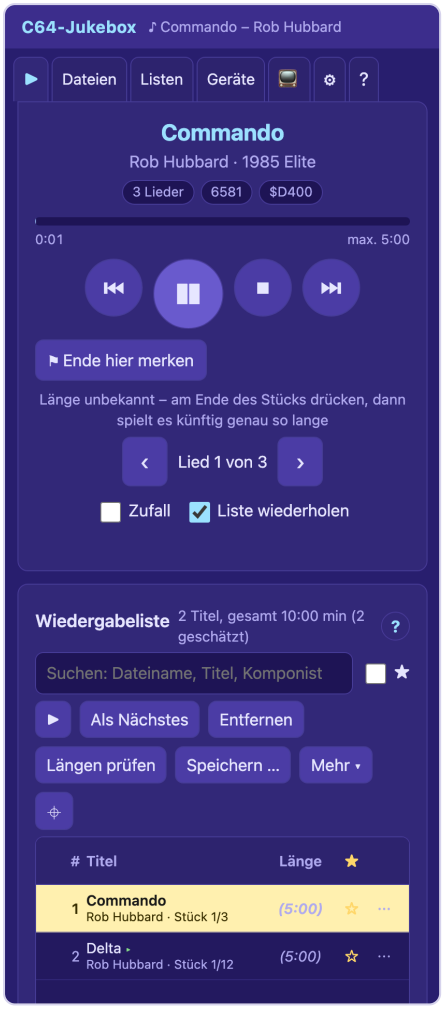
3 · Choosing music – tab *Dateien*



Sources at the top, below the open folder with title, composer, year and sub-tunes

- **Sources** are tiles at the top: a network share (NAS, Windows, Mac), an FTP server, the USB stick on the Ultimate or a USB stick on the Pi. Tap to open, ✎ edits, **+ Quelle** (add source) sets up a new one (with a network search). The jukebox remembers the last folder of each source.
- Tap a **folder** to open it; the path line above leads back with one tap.
- **Tap a SID** (or ▶) to play it – and after it the other files of the folder. The current list is replaced.
- **+** appends a file to the list without interrupting playback.
- ▶ ***Ordner abspielen*** (play folder) takes all SIDs of the folder – with *mit Unterordnern* (with subfolders) from all subfolders too, with *Zufall* (shuffle) mixed. **+ Liste** appends them instead.
- **Filter field:** works on the open folder at once (file name, title, composer, year; several words must all match, e.g. `hubbard 1986`).
- 🔍 ***Unterordner*** searches the word in **all subfolders** (up to 500 hits); “play folder” then plays the hits, ✕ in the path line leads back.
- Yellow **2 SIDs** / **3 SIDs** marks stereo tunes.
- **Song lengths and STIL:** in the HVSC folder `C64Music/DOCUMENTS` tap *als HVSC-Längen laden* (load as HVSC lengths) at `Songlengths.md5` and *als STIL laden* at `STIL.txt`. The jukebox then changes exactly at the end of a tune and shows background notes on the tunes.

4 · Playback and the list – tab ▶

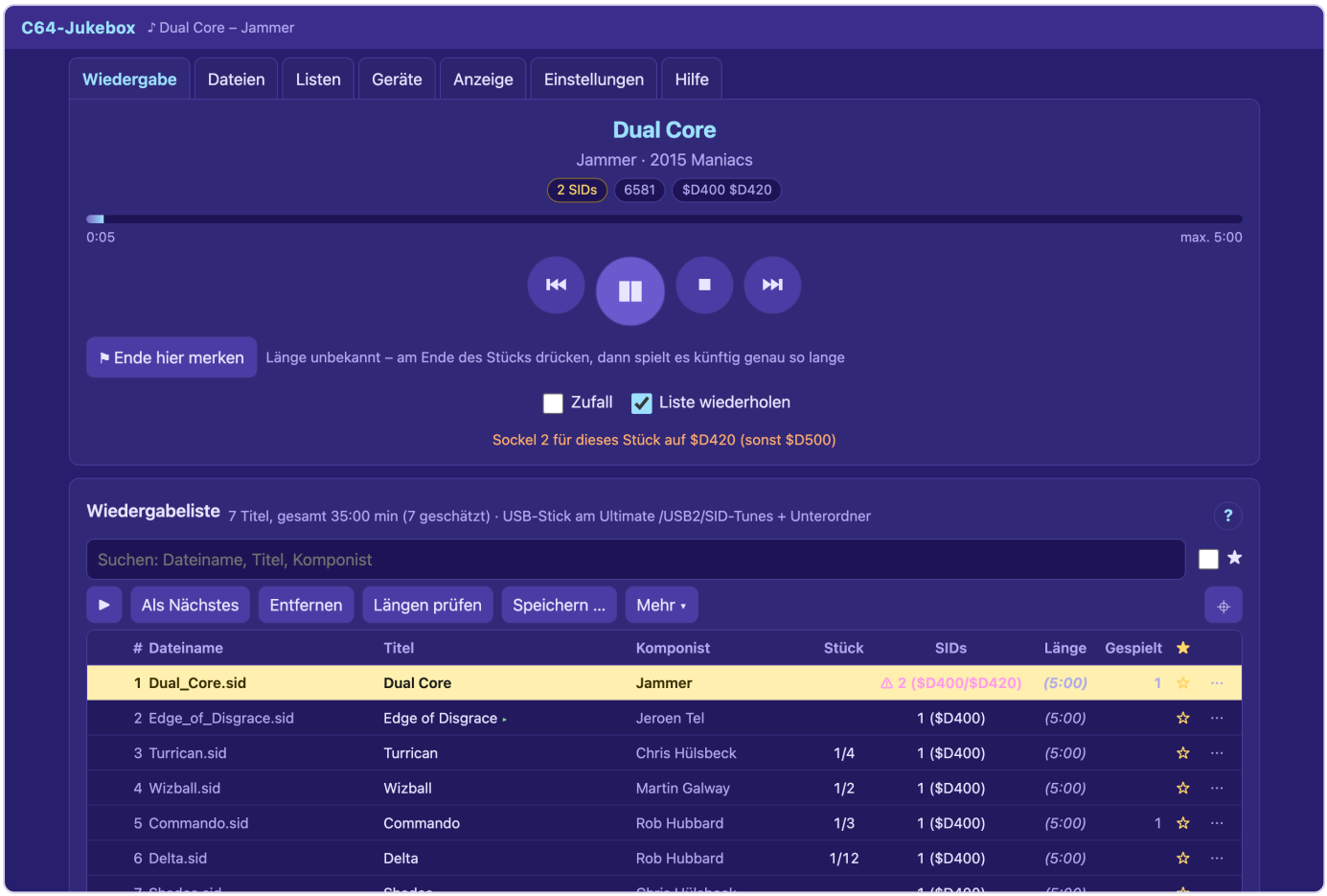


Current tune, buttons and the playlist below (on the phone)

Button	Effect
⏮	to the start of the tune; within the first 5 s to the previous tune
▶ / ⏸	play or pause (the Ultimate is paused) and resume
■	stop – the Ultimate is reset
⏭	next tune
‹ Lied 1 von 3 ›	another sub-tune of the current tune
Zufall	shuffle; tunes played less often come up sooner
Liste wiederholen	repeat the list, otherwise the jukebox stops at its end
Ultimate	with several Ultimates: which one plays

- **Progress bar:** with a known length to the end, otherwise to the time limit (“max. 5:00”).
- ⚑ ***Ende hier merken*** (remember the end here) appears while a tune without a known length plays: press it at the end of the tune – the playing time becomes its length, and from then on it plays exactly that long.
- **Suggestions:** if the jukebox finds out by itself where a tune starts over (“Fängt nach 1:35 von vorn an”), or finds the same tune in the HVSC, it shows *Übernehmen* (accept) / *Nein*.
- Below the title: the SID chips, the STIL notes and, if needed, a SID socket change (“Sockel 2 für dieses Stück auf $D420”).

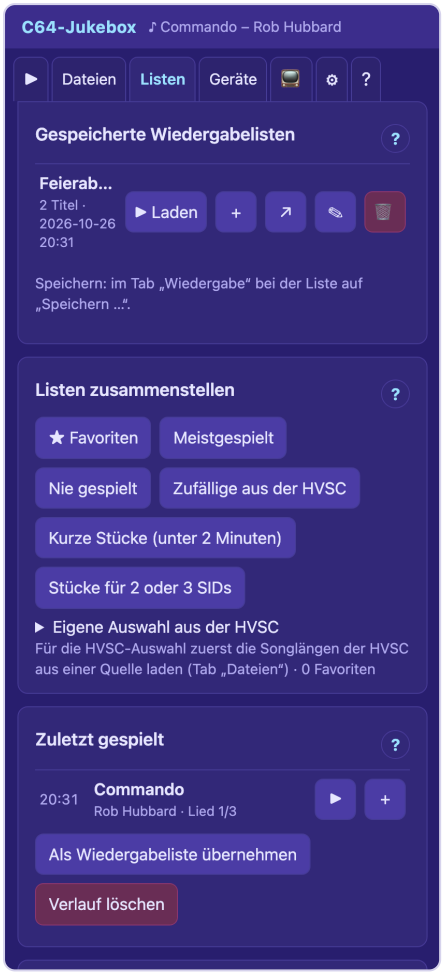
The playlist



On the PC the list shows all columns: file name, title, composer, sub-tune, SIDs, length, times played, favourite. The current tune is yellow, a green ▸ marks the next one.

- **Play:** double-tap or double-click (on the PC also Enter).
- **Select:** tap; on the PC with Ctrl/⌘ several, with Shift a range.
- ⋯ at a tune (or right-click): play, play next, choose sub-tune, own length, favourite, show in the files tab, remove from the list.
- ***Als Nächstes*** (next) puts the selected tunes right after the current one; ***Entfernen*** removes them.
- Tap ★ to make a tune a favourite; the ★ tick above the list shows favourites only.
- **Sort:** tap a column header; on the PC drag rows with the mouse.
- **Search:** the field above the list searches file name, title and composer.
- **Lengths** in the column: `3:05` from the HVSC, `3:05*` own, `(5:00)` grey = unknown (the time limit applies). ***Längen prüfen*** (check lengths) looks for missing lengths in the HVSC.
- ***Speichern …*** saves the list under a name (see tab “Listen”).
- ***Mehr*** ▾ (more): import/export a playlist of the PC jukebox, *Entdecken* (discover a rarely played tune), *Stopp nach …* (stop after a number of tunes or minutes), select all, clear the list.
- **Keys on the PC:** Space play/pause, ← → previous/next tune.

5 · Lists – tab *Listen*



Saved lists, compilations and “recently played”

Saved playlists

▶ ***Laden*** (load) replaces the current list and plays it, **+** appends it, ↗ exports it for the PC jukebox, ✎ renames, 🗑 deletes. Lists are saved in the tab ▶ with *Speichern …*.

Ready-made compilations

One tap plays at once: ★ **Favoriten** (favourites), **Meistgespielt** (most played), **Nie gespielt** (never played), **Zufällige aus der HVSC** (random from the HVSC), **Kurze Stücke** (short tunes), **Stücke für 2 oder 3 SIDs** (tunes for 2 or 3 SIDs). Under *Eigene Auswahl aus der HVSC* (own selection) you can choose by area (musicians, games, demos), composer, length, number of SIDs, STIL notes and “never played”. This needs the HVSC song lengths loaded from a source.

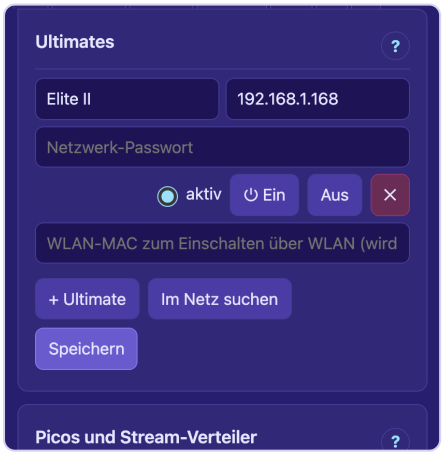
Recently played

The last 100 tunes with the time, newest first. ▶ plays one next, **+** appends it, *Als Wiedergabeliste übernehmen* turns the history into a new list, *Verlauf löschen* clears it.

Statistics

How often what was played – counts and favourites belong to the file, also in other lists.

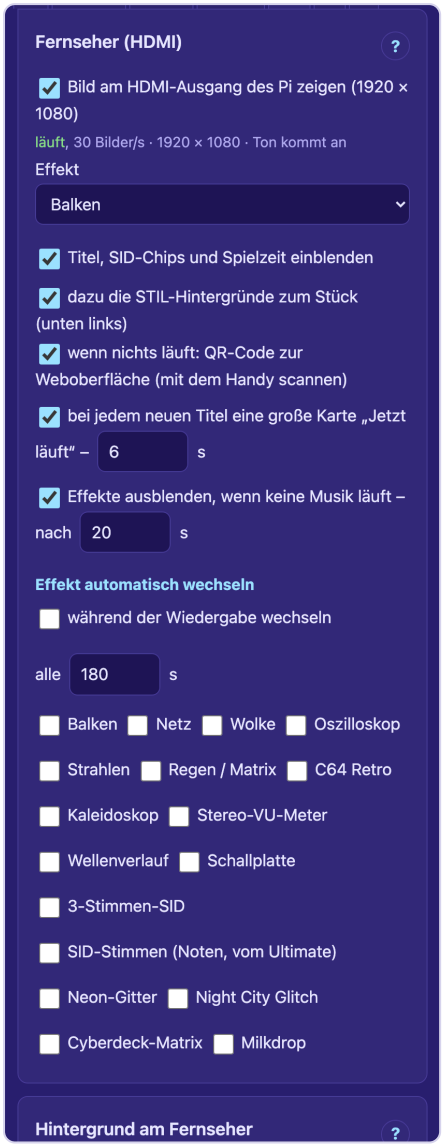
6 · Devices – tab *Geräte*



Card “Ultimates”

- **Ultimates:** name and **Ethernet address** of each Ultimate (*Im Netz suchen* – search the network – finds them), the network password if set. *aktiv* (active) = this one plays. Don't forget *Speichern* (save).
- ⏻ ***Ein / Aus*** (on/off): *Aus* stops playback and switches the Ultimate off, *Ein* wakes it over its WLAN (Ultimate 64-II). The jukebox learns the WLAN MAC for this itself.
- **Picos and stream distributor:** the Pi passes the Ultimate's sound on to visualizers and audio receivers and sends them titles and retro news – setup see the guide to the C64 ecosystem.
- **Devices in the network:** all Picos and the Pi with the way of the sound; *als Pico eintragen* (add as Pico) adds a device to the distributor's list.

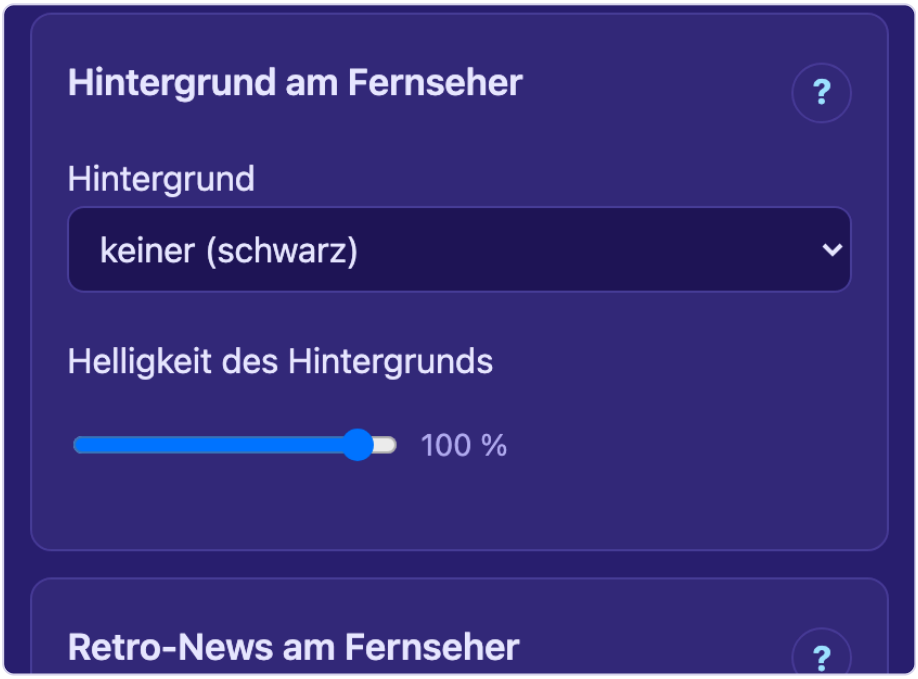
7 · Display: TV and screen – tab 📺



Card “Fernseher (HDMI)”

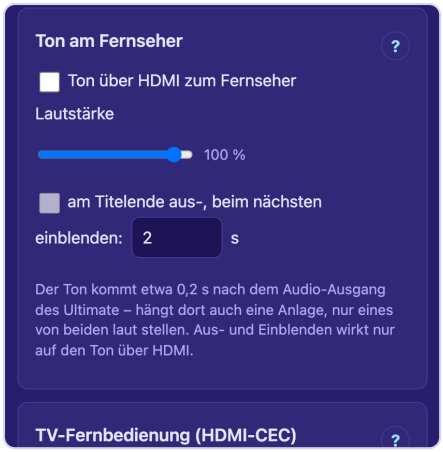
TV (HDMI)

- *Bild am HDMI-Ausgang des Pi zeigen* (show a picture on the Pi's HDMI output) switches the output on. Every change applies at once – you see on the TV right away how a style looks.
- ***Effekt*** (style): one of 17 (as in the PC jukebox) or “background only”.
- **Overlays:** title, SID chips and playing time; STIL notes at the bottom left; a QR code when nothing plays; the big **“now playing” card** for every new tune (duration adjustable).
- **Hide styles** when no music plays (after 20 s).
- **Change style automatically:** tick styles and *während der Wiedergabe wechseln* – a different one every 180 s.



Card “Hintergrund am Fernseher” (background on the TV)

Background: none, **pictures** (slide show: upload them or choose a folder of a source, e.g. on the NAS; change every 20 s with cross-fade) or the **C64's picture** live from the Ultimate. “Brightness of the background” dims it.



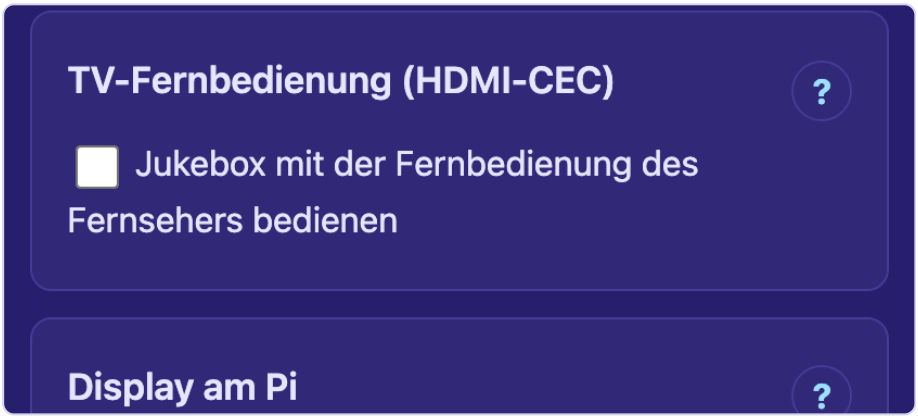
Card “Ton am Fernseher” (sound on the TV)

Sound on the TV

Ton über HDMI zum Fernseher plays the Ultimate's sound through the TV. **Volume** (0–100 %) makes it quieter without looking for the remote. With *am Titelende aus-, beim nächsten einblenden* the tunes fade into each other (only on the TV; the Ultimate itself plays unchanged). If a stereo is connected to the Ultimate as well, turn up only one of them – the TV is about 0.2 s later.

Retro news on the TV

Headlines from retro pages (Indie Retro News, amiga-news.de, Commodore News …): **in idle mode** as a big card, **as a ticker** at the bottom during the music. Every source can be switched on and off, own feeds with **+ Quelle**.

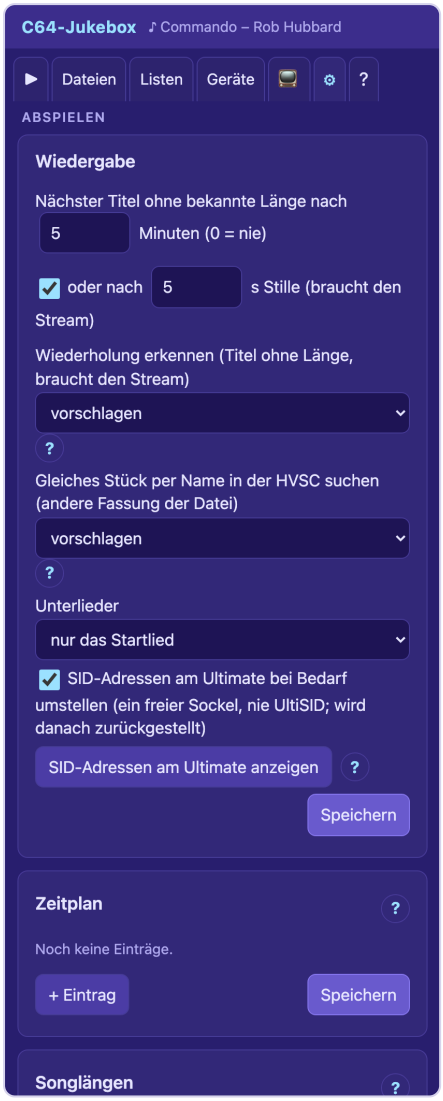


Card “TV-Fernbedienung (HDMI-CEC)” – see section 10

Display on the Pi

Type of display (small OLED or 2.8″ with touch), set up touch, rotate the picture, after how many minutes it goes dark – see section 11.

8 · Settings – tab ⚙



Playing: playback and timer

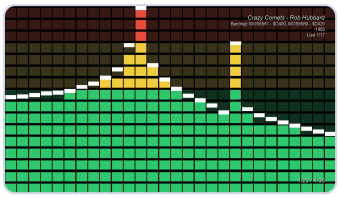
Playing

Setting	Effect
Next tune without a known length after … minutes	time limit (default 5, 0 = never)
or after … s of silence	moves on when a tune ends and goes silent (needs the stream)
Detect repeats	suggests a length when a tune starts over – *suggest*, *automatic* or *off*
Find the same tune by name in the HVSC	take the length of another version of the same music
Sub-tunes	*only the start tune* or *all one after the other*
Switch SID addresses when needed	sets a free SID socket of the Ultimate to the address a stereo tune needs, and back afterwards

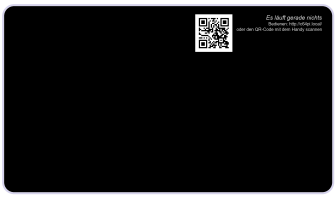
- **Timer:** play a list or stop at fixed times, e.g. weekdays at 18:00 “Feierabend” – with the TV on/off if wanted.
- **Song lengths:** upload or remove the HVSC file, download own lengths; remove STIL.
- **Take over data of the PC jukebox:** play counts, favourites and own lengths.
- **WLAN and network:** choose a WLAN (for the Pi without a cable), the Pi's own WLAN; **party mode** for away from home without a router.
- Change the **web password**; download and restore a **backup** (all settings, sources, lists and own lengths in one file).

9 · On the TV

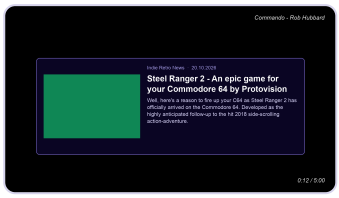
On the HDMI output the Pi shows styles to the music at 1920 × 1080 – over black, a slide show or the C64's live picture. **Top right** are title, composer, the SID chips needed, year and sub-tune, **bottom right** the playing time. For every new tune the **“now playing” card** appears for a moment.



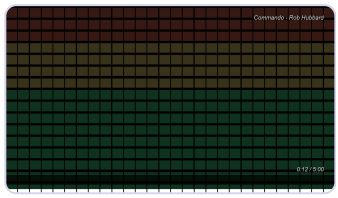
Style “bars” with the details top right



Nothing playing: note with a QR code to the web page

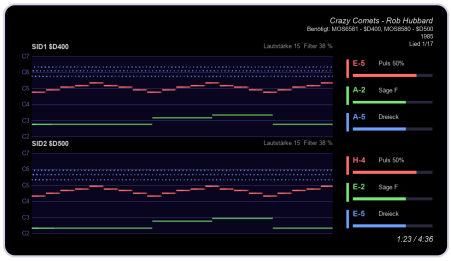


Retro news as a card in idle mode

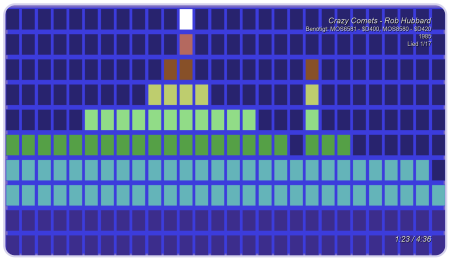


Retro news as a ticker during the music

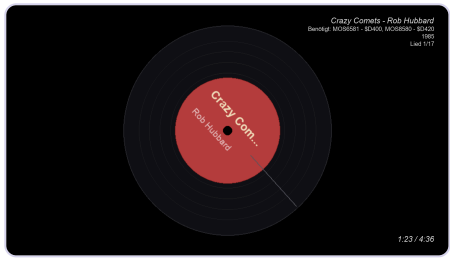
Some of the 17 styles



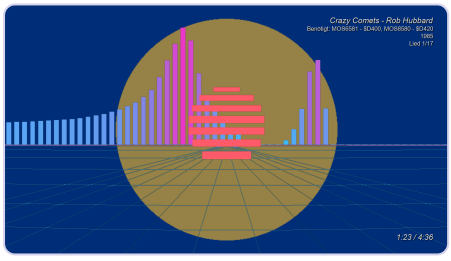
SID voices: the real voices of each SID as a note roll



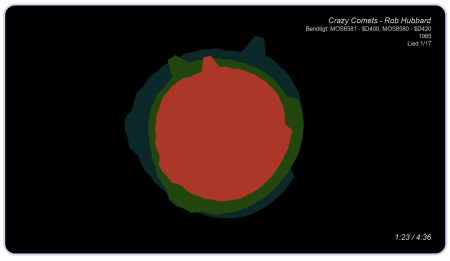
C64 Retro



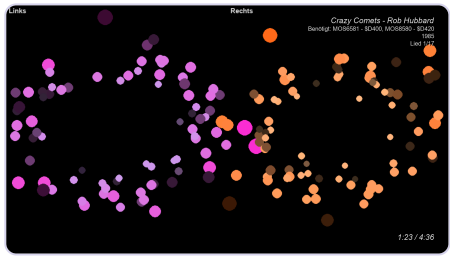
Record



Neon grid



Milkdrop



Cloud

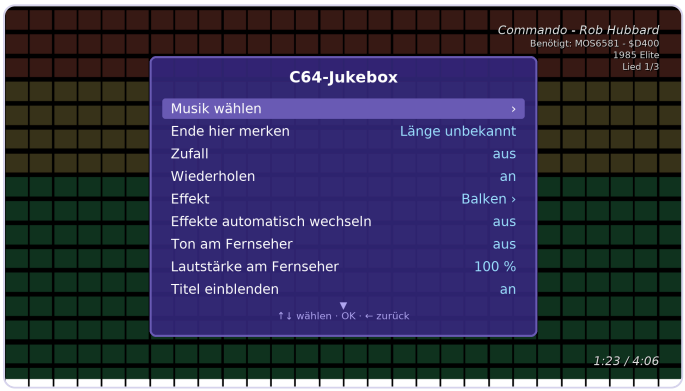
> **SID voices** shows the three voices of each SID for the last 5 seconds (pitch upwards, voice 1 red, 2 green, 3 blue, brighter = louder), on the right note, waveform and level. For this the Ultimate's **“Debug Stream Mode”** (under *Data Streams*) must include a 6510 part (default “6510 Only”), and it does not work together with the background “C64 picture”.

10 · Remote control and menu on the TV

Switch on: tab 📺 , card **TV-Fernbedienung (HDMI-CEC)**, tick *Jukebox mit der Fernbedienung des Fernsehers bedienen*. CEC must be on at the TV (called e.g. *Anynet+*, *SimpLink*, *Bravia Sync*, *VIERA Link*). Most TVs send the keys only to the device they are showing – so switch to the Pi's input (or use *Fernseher jetzt auf den Pi umschalten* in the card).

Key	Effect
▶ ⏸	stop while music plays – play when stopped
■	stop
⏭ ⏮ · ⏩ ⏪ · → ←	next / previous tune
↑ ↓	next / previous style on the TV
Channel + −	next / previous sub-tune
OK or a menu key	opens the **menu on the TV**

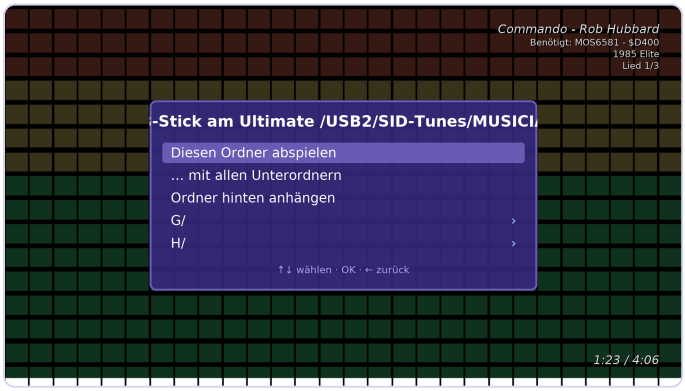
In the menu: ↑ ↓ choose, **OK** or → run or open, **Back** or ← one level back (at the top: close). After 30 s without a key it closes by itself. ▶, ■, ⏭ and ⏮ also work with the menu open.



The main menu



Musik wählen (choose music): sources, compilations, saved lists



Browsing the folders of a source



Choosing the style (● = the current one)

Menu item	What it does
Musik wählen (choose music)	sources (“Ordner: …”) to browse – *Diesen Ordner abspielen* (play this folder), *… mit allen Unterordnern* (with all subfolders), *Ordner hinten anhängen* (append folder), a file plays the folder from there –, the compilations (favourites, most played, never played, random from the HVSC, short tunes, tunes for 2 or 3 SIDs) and all saved lists (play, append, rename, delete)
Ende hier merken / *Erkannte Länge übernehmen* / *HVSC-Länge übernehmen*	only for a tune without a known length: the playing time or the length found becomes its length
Zufall, *Wiederholen*	shuffle, repeat on/off
Effekt, *Effekte automatisch wechseln*	choose the style, automatic change on/off
Ton am Fernseher, *Lautstärke am Fernseher*	sound over HDMI on/off; every OK one step quieter (100 → 90 … 10 → 100)
Titel einblenden	the details top right on/off
Längen prüfen	looks for missing lengths in the HVSC; then “… HVSC-Längen übernehmen” (accept)
Ultimate	which one plays (● = active), *Im Netzwerk suchen* (search), add new ones with “+ name”
Ultimate einschalten / *ausschalten*	wake it over its WLAN or switch it off (asks first)

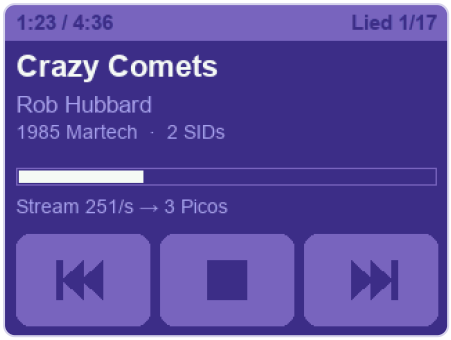


Renaming a list with the on-screen keyboard: arrows choose, OK types, Back deletes, *Fertig* (done) accepts

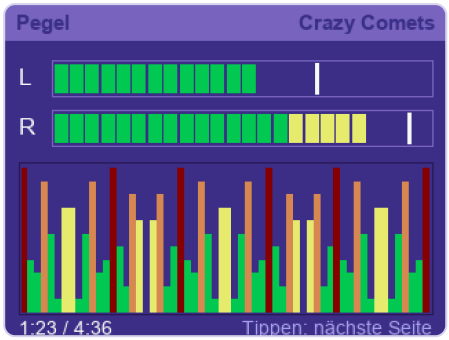
Notes appear discreetly above the playing time, e.g. “Fängt nach 1:35 von vorn an · OK: als Länge übernehmen” (starts over after 1:35 · OK: take as length) – **OK** then opens the menu at the right item, a second OK accepts.

In the card **TV-Fernbedienung** you can also set the TV to switch on and change to the Pi when the music starts, and to switch off when nothing has played for a while.

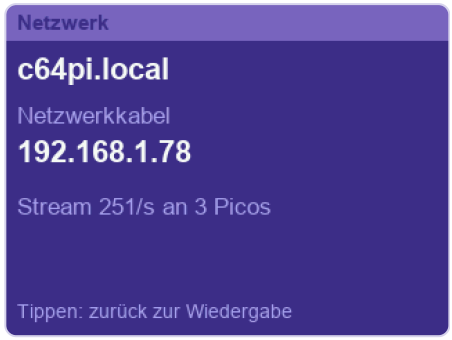
11 · Touch display on the Pi



Playback with the buttons ⏮ ■ ⏭



Levels left/right, below the last 15 s



Network: address, WLAN, distributor, Ultimate

- **Buttons:** ⏮ previous tune, ■ stop (or ▶ play when nothing plays), ⏭ next tune.
- **A tap outside the buttons** changes to the next page for 30 s: playback → levels → network.
- After 10 minutes without playback it goes dark (adjustable); **the first tap only wakes it**, the second one operates.
- The touch reacts to pressure – best tap with a fingernail or a stylus. *Touch einrichten* (set up touch; tab 🖥️, card “Display am Pi”) shows three crosses to tap if taps land beside the buttons.
- In the Pi's own WLAN the display shows name, password and address in large letters.

12 · Quick help

What you see	What helps
`c64pi.local` does not work	Use the IP address: QR code on the TV or the Pi's display, otherwise in the router's list.
The remote does nothing	Switch the TV to the Pi's input (or “Fernseher jetzt auf den Pi umschalten”); switch CEC on at the TV; check the tick in the card “TV-Fernbedienung”.
No sound on the TV, styles do not move	The sound comes as a stream from the Ultimate: is the Ultimate on and entered with its Ethernet address? Are *Data Streams* allowed in the Ultimate?
Tunes always run 5 minutes	Length unknown: load the HVSC song lengths (tab Dateien), press “Ende hier merken” at the end or accept the suggestions.
A voice is missing in a stereo tune	Switch on “switch SID addresses when needed”; ⚠ in the column “SIDs” marks tunes that do not match the Ultimate's setting.
SID voices: a note instead of notes	Switch on “Debug Stream Mode” at the Ultimate; not together with the background “C64 picture”.
Password forgotten	see the manual, chapter “Passwort vergessen” (reset over SSH).

C64 Jukebox · Copyright © 2026 Sedor (der-sedor.de) · free software under the GNU General Public License, version 3. “Commodore”, “C64”, “SID” and “Ultimate 64” / “C64 Ultimate” are trademarks of their respective owners; this project is not affiliated with them.